



D.Yoga code : Yama

*"yogena chittasya padena vacham
malam sharirasya cha vaidyakena
yo'pakarottamam pravaram muninam
patanjalin pranjaliranato'smi"*

Yoga rules

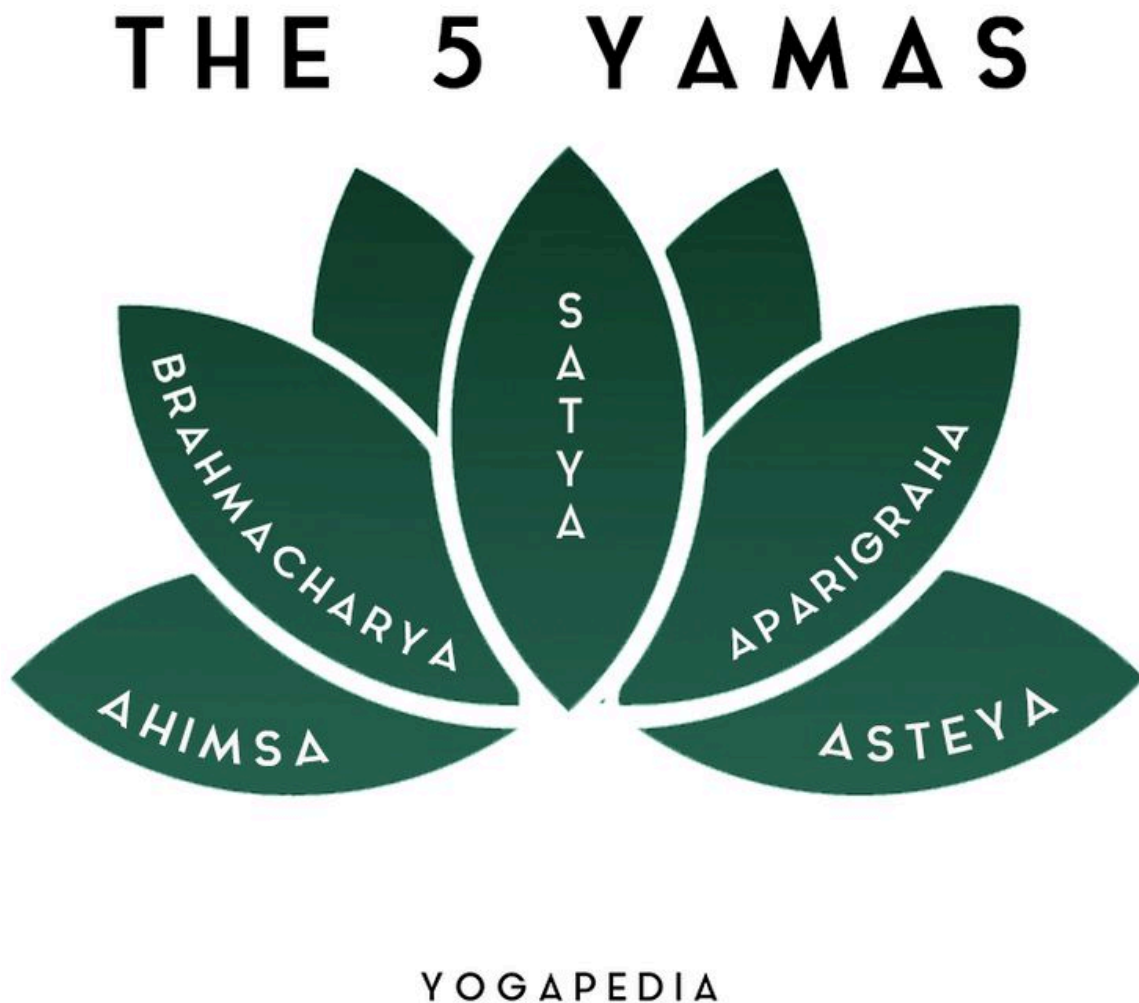
To follow the path of yoga, the sadhaka must follow rules. Yoga defines two types of rules : **social rules, or Yama**, and **moral rules, or Niyama**. If you don't follow these rules, it's impossible to progress further in yoga. There are 5 Yama and 5 Niyama. A clear analogy can be drawn with the Ten Commandments of the Bible. This analogy highlights the universal nature of schools of thought and religions.

Yama

1. **Ahimsa** : non-violence
2. **Satya** : honesty, integrity

3. **Asteya** : non stealing
4. **Brahmacharya** : celibacy
5. **Aparigraha** : no accumulation

The yamas are also known as **the 5 great vows**.



Ahimsa (non-violence)

When we speak of non-violence, we first think of physical violence (Thou shalt not kill), but Ahimsa encompasses **all forms of non-violence on all forms of life**.

There's physical non-violence, verbal non-violence and non-violent thought towards human beings, animals and plants.

Violent negative thoughts can influence a person or a living being : an experiment was carried out by scientists, in which they grew two plants in two different rooms.

In the first room, the plant was watered with love and positive thoughts; in the other room, the other plant was watered with contempt and negative thoughts.

The result was spectacular: the plant subjected to the positive thoughts was **lush and beautiful**, while the other was withered and puny...

There are cases where violence can be used as long as the intention is more important: if you're a soldier, your intention is to save 10 other people.

If the intention is to protect others, it would be violence to judge a soldier he uses violence to protect... (vast debate...)



"Make love and food not war nor violence"

Supa Mega Master Jedi-Yogi-Ninja-Diver-Rider-Surfer-Shaolin-Cool Monkey D. Luffy

Satya : integrity

We must be honest in our speech, heart and thoughts towards others and **above all towards ourselves.**

It's very hard to admit that we're really wrong. Being honest means first of all being honest with ourselves: realizing what our qualities and, above all, our faults are, and then being honest with others, otherwise **we'd just be blaming others.**

Satya and the other Yamas have been established so that a Yogi can live in harmony with society.

If Ahimsa is not applied, we cannot be in Satya, because our **ego tends to want to express its truth.**

There are many expressions linked to the truth (Satya) that can hurt a person in an argument, such as "the truth comes out of a child's mouth" or "only the truth hurts." These two **expressions take on a whole new impact if we apply Ahimsa.**

Truth is something that has always been present, **a child is pure in his thoughts and without prejudice**, he can only speak **the truth.**

It's often said that "only the truth hurts" when we want to make a criticism or a point. It's a very common mistake which many beginner yogis make.

We need (Me first!) to stop being violent in their speech in order not to offend the other (Ahimsa).

However, in an excess of zeal for Ahimsa, we

can forget honesty (satya) and end up lying to ourselves or to others.

As with the soldier example, you can criticize a person (or yourself) if the intention

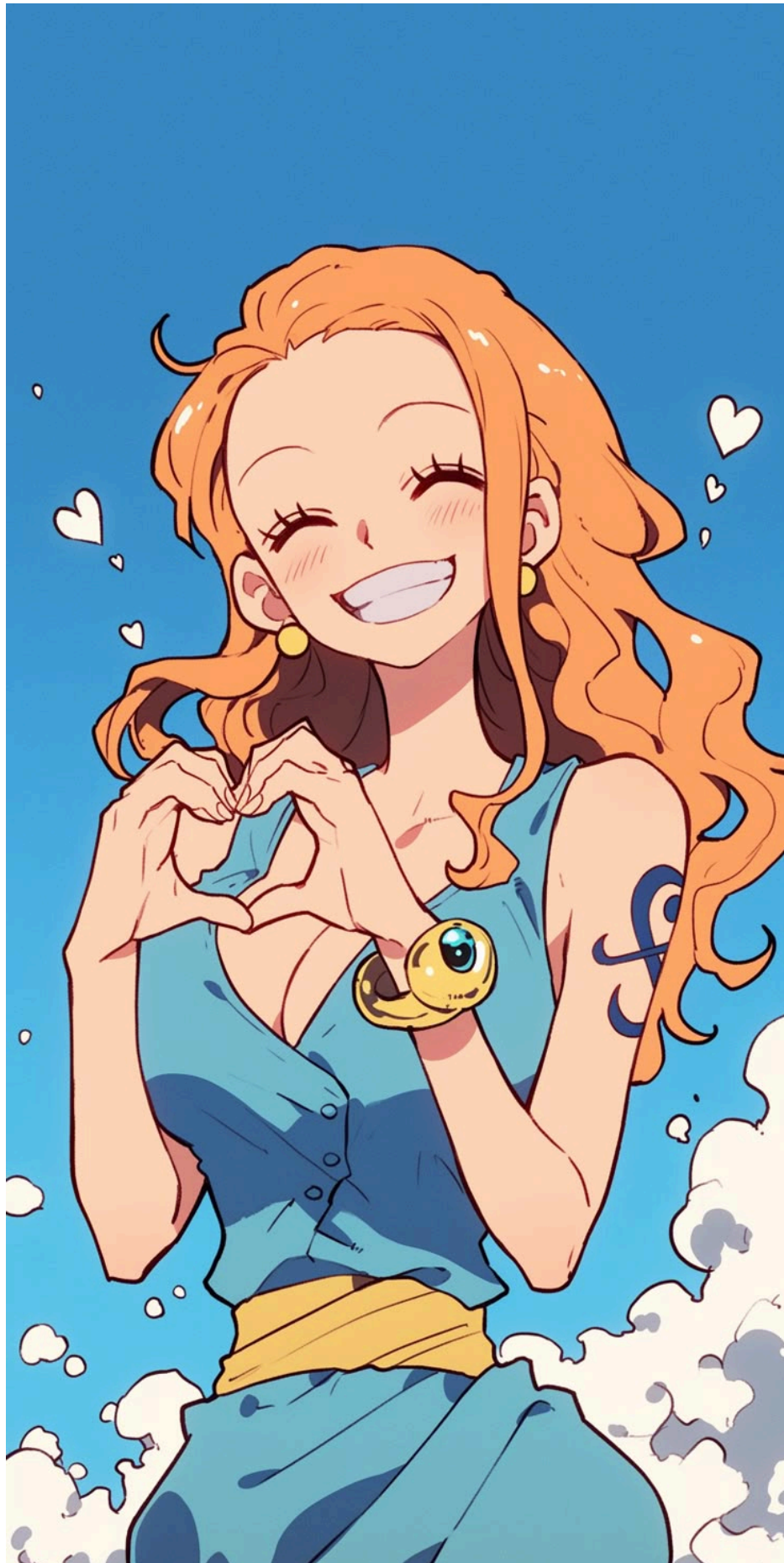
is more important (e.g. to criticize the person in order that he improves their postures or his practices).



"Since the moment I have applied Satya, I have understood that I was lying to myself because I didn't believe in My Soul. That's why I have lied so many times, I was listening to my fears..." Padawan D."God" Ussop

Asteya : Don't steal

There's no need to explain why stealing can be problematic in society. From a Yogi perspective, consuming too much of nature's resources is considered theft. **We're stealing from Nature.** If you teach a discipline or art that you're actually experienced, that's theft : you're **stealing knowledge**. Stealing knowledge won't bring you any apprehension of it. It's only by following all the Yama that you'll obtain true knowledge.



"Non stealing is also a detachment from D.esire. Once you let go, you can experience a fresh feeling of lightness" Padawan D.Nami

Brahmacharya : Celibacy

Brahma means "universe" and Charya "abstinence." Brahmacharya literally means

saving Cosmic Energy, and the most powerful energy is sexual energy. If a yogi wants to reach the highest spheres of yoga, he will need to save all this sexual energy within himself instead of using it outwardly.

Brahmacharya immediately brings to mind monastic life,

sexual abstinence and the associated severity. In reality, this Yama is **more flexible** : many Yogis are fathers or mothers. The essential idea of

Brahmacharya is to know how to **moderate** oneself in order to **conserve this energy**. We think mainly of sexual energy, but there are many other ways to save energy, and **not using it is practicing Brahmacharya**, eating in silence is turning off a light because you're not using it.



"If you practice Brahmacharya, you can only be... SUUUUUPPPAAAA COOOL"
Padawan Franky D.

An exercise you can do : is a Brahmacharya practice for 4 hours.

No distractions, (no music, no reading, no TV, no screen, non speaking , no writing etc...), no sleeping, only breathing and meditation.

If you practice trully, you would be able to experience the benefits of Bramacharya.

Aparigraha: Non-accumulation

This Yama implies not accumulating too many objects in the purpose, to be able to detach oneself from them. If we accumulate too many objects, we tend to worry about them.

Practicing Aparigraha means using what is really necessary. Once you know what's really necessary, this really helps with Vairagya, which implies detachment from everything.

However, living with nothing can be a cause of Klesha. There is this Yogini who went teaching for free in orphanage but she could not live the place, because she had no money. If the non-accumulation is most of the time good, to be radical can cause you unhappiness.



"Only the strict minimum is necessary to enjoy life" Freeman Naked D. Gaiman